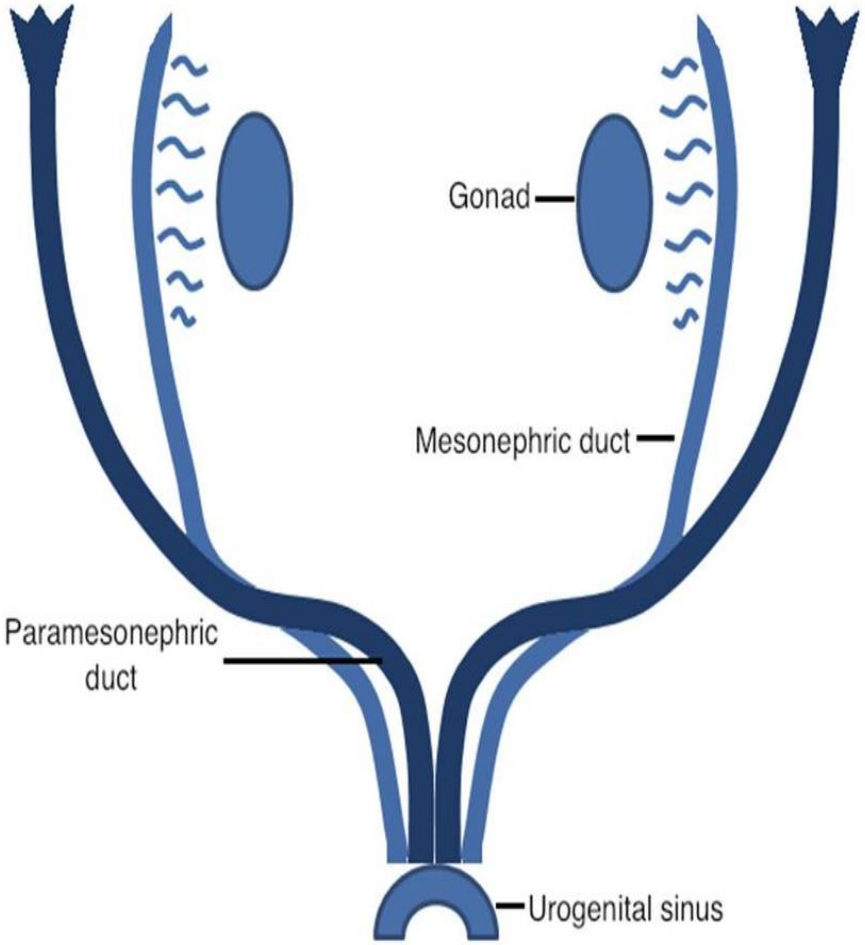
Development of the genital ducts

- Initially, both male and female embryos have two pairs of genital ducts: ***mesonephric*** (**Wolffian**) ducts and ***paramesonephric*** (**Müllerian**) ducts.

- The testis secretes:

1- Testosterone that stimulates the development of mesonephric ducts.

2- Antimullerian hormone that suppresses the paramesonephric ducts



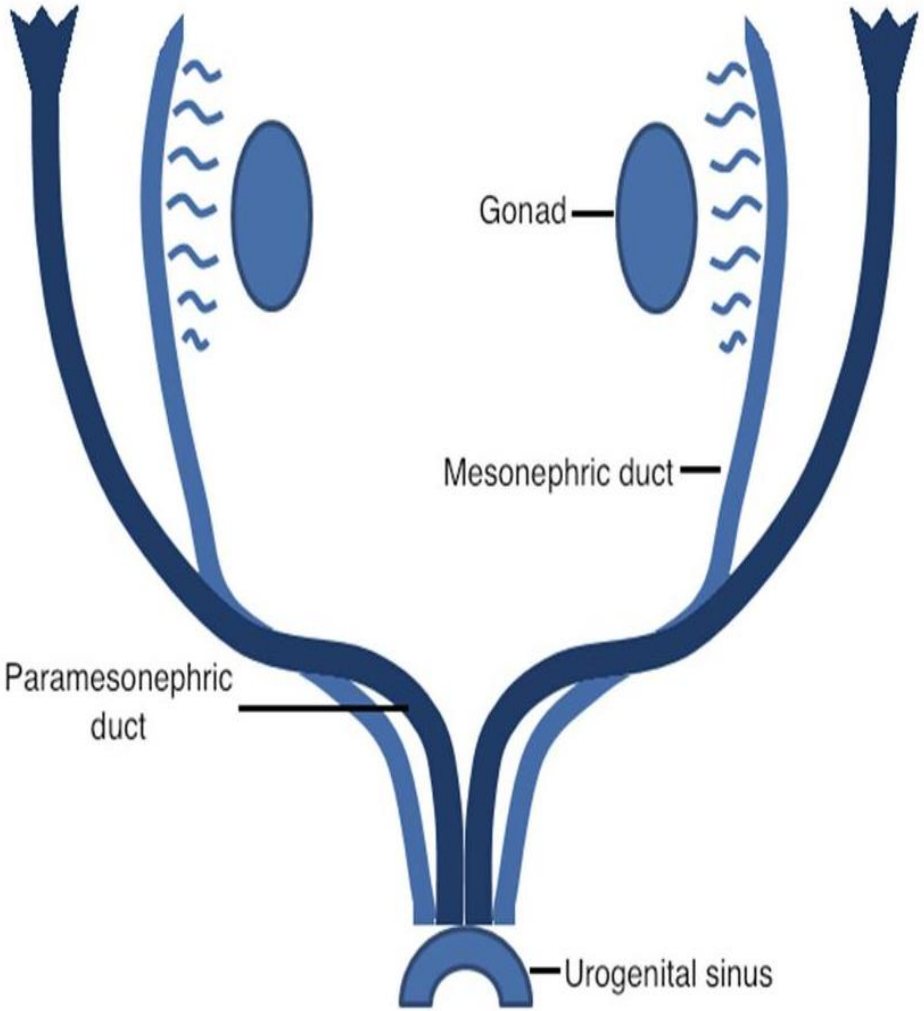
Development of the genital ducts

- Mesonephric duct & tubules:

The kidney develops in 3 sets; pronephros, mesonephros and metanephros (permanent kidney).

- The mesonephros has mesonephric tubules that open in the mesonephric ducts.

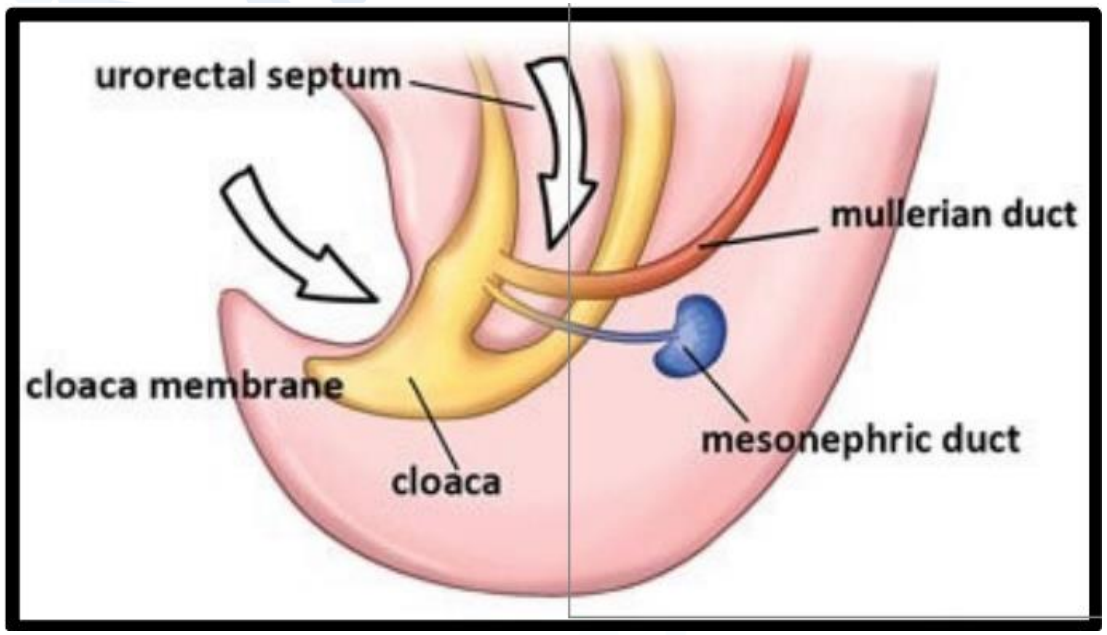
- The mesonephric ducts open into the urogenital sinus.

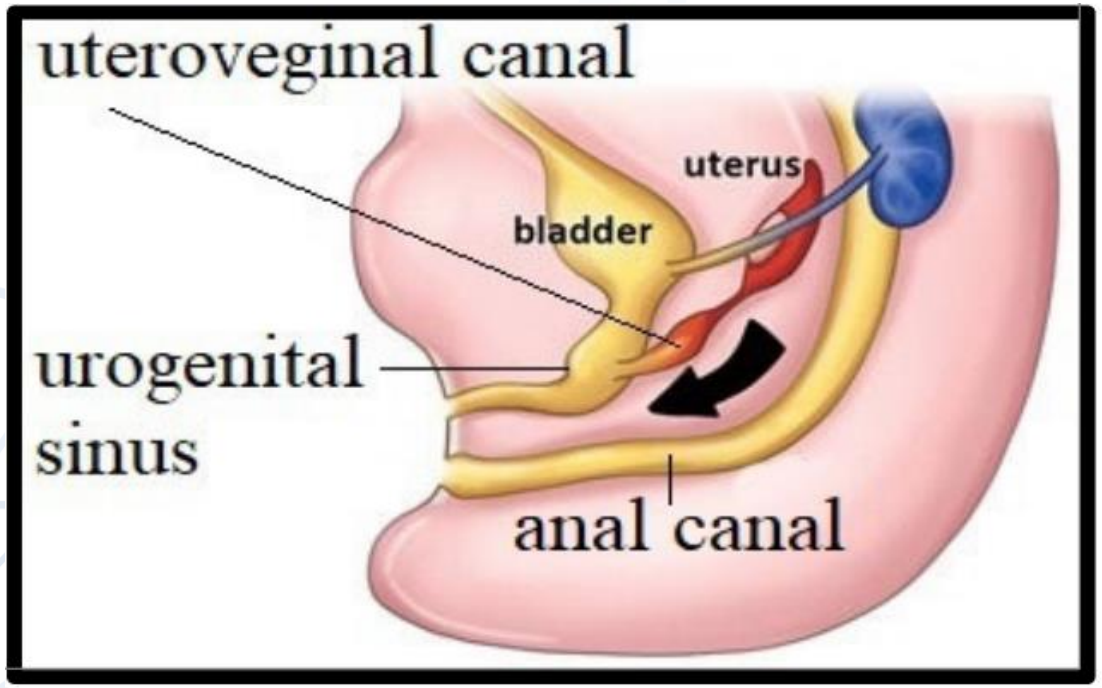


- Urogenital sinus :

- The distal part of the hindgut (endoderm) is called cloaca.

- The urorectal septum divides the cloaca into the urogenital sinus anteriorly and the anal canal posteriorly.





Paramesonephric duct :

- It arises as a longitudinal invagination of the epithelium lateral to the mesonephric duct.

- Its upper end opens into the abdominal cavity.
- It first runs lateral to the mesonephric duct, crosses it anteriorly to its medial side and then grows downwards.

